Joyce Zhu

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Qualifications

- Experienced in web/desktop accessibility: WCAG guidelines, ARIA authoring patterns.
- **Programming Languages:** I've used a wide variety; I'm mostly in Typescript these days but I'll learn anything!

Experience

GITHUB — REMOTE

Senior Software Engineer — **Summer 2022 -**

- Currently: Designing and implementing accessibility-related fixes and user settings for the Copilot app.
- Architected and wrote full technical specification for accessible modes of navigation and interactions in the 2022 React-based UI update + rewrite of GitHub's code viewer.
- Advocated for and staffed the creation of an internal library for registering keyboard shortcuts in a centralized React-based store; delivered talks on accessible keyboard shortcut usage and internal documentation to promote increasingly widespread adoption as more of GitHub UI is implemented in React.
- Managed / mentored 2 interns to create the first public plugin for GitHub's accessibility scanner (which incorporates optional integration with Copilot to provide alt text quality feedback) and publish a blog post on their work.

QUIP (SLACK) — SAN FRANCISCO, CA / REMOTE

Software Engineer (Staff Software Engineer) — **Summer 2017 – Summer 2022**

- **Accessibility TL**: code review and mentorship for 3-4 engineers, architecture and design doc review for accessible systems across engineering, staff accessibility help chat, reactive coding and debugging for high-touch customer issues, identifying and filing accessibility-related bugs in browsers and screen readers.
- Reduced number of VPAT (external accessibility audit) bugs found from 194 (Dec 2019) to 39 (Nov 2021), including going from no to almost full support for WCAG Reflow criteria, while simultaneously increasing testing surface area to span all in-product document editing.
- Previously: Standardized and oversaw all native release processes, implemented numerous enterprise-related requested features (e.g. custom session expiry times), wrote lexer and parser for odd formatted text language.

edX — CAMBRIDGE, MA

Software Engineering Intern — **Summer 2016**

- Separated API endpoints from monolithic Open edX platform to independently-deployed ecommerce microservice.

PIXABILITY, INC. — BOSTON, MA

Python Software Engineering Intern — **May 2015–April 2016**

- Designed and implemented JSON-based query language for users to create query filters of arbitrary complexity.

Press

https://blog.powertofly.com/accessible-design-and-engineering — **2021**

- Feature on my team's work to build accessible testing and architecture review into the product process at Quip.

Education

UNIVERSITY OF ROCHESTER — ROCHESTER, NY

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science; Bachelor of Arts in Music — **May 2017**

- **GPA of 3.95** (out of 4.0), *magna cum laude* with highest distinction, Dean's List all semesters.

Writing/Publications

- Making the Quip Editor Accessible: 2022 blog post
- **Joyce Zhu**, Jeremy Warner, Mitchell Gordon, Jeffery White, Renan Zanelatto, Philip J. Guo. **Toward a Domain-Specific Visual Discussion Forum for Learning Computer Programming: An Empirical Study of a Popular MOOC Forum.** *IEEE Symposium on Visual Languages and Human-Centric Computing (VL/HCC)*, Oct 2015.